

Figure 4: Radar plot

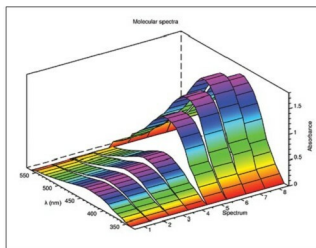


Figure 5: Ribbon plot

end of the article). The original data are easily converted to the triangular coordinates using the parameters 'xx' and 'yy'. The coloured grids are built using a particular loop containing a combination of the primitives `xset` and `xpoly`. All the labels are written with a LaTeX notation. The code is partially based on the Gnuplot code written by Atsushi Noda (<http://staff.aist.go.jp/a.noda/programs/ternary/ternary-en.html>).

Time plot

Sometimes, it's necessary to observe how a parameter varies over time. The plot has the parameter on the y axis and the time on the x axis. In this example, the data is organised in four columns: *year*, *month*, *day* and *price of the diesel fuel*. The function `datenum` is first used to convert the original data (the first three columns) to the x coordinates and then the function `datevec` is used to create the labels on the x axis. Last, a 'fast' cubic spline is used for connecting the points.

If you are in need of a plot type that's not available in Scilab, by default, you can write it with some lines of code. The code necessary for the calculations is relatively short and most of it (and perhaps, the most boring part) is dedicated to

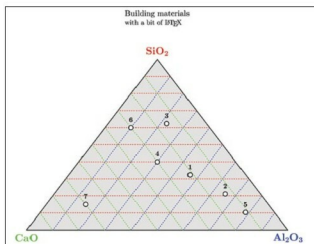


Figure 6: Ternary plot

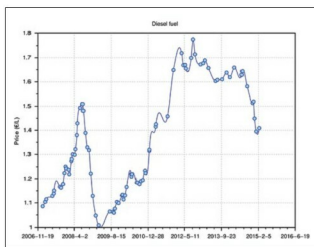


Figure 7: Time plot

the colour and label settings. There are also other plot types that can be reproduced in Scilab fairly easily. 

References

- [1] <http://usingscilab.blogspot.it/2012/09/plot3d2-creating-cube.html>, last visited on 27/03/2015.
- [2] http://sdb.sdb.aist.go.jp/sdb/cgi-bin/direct_frame_top.cgi, last visited on 27/03/2015.
- [3] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ternary_plot, last visited on 27/03/2015.
- [4] Büchner, Schliebs, Winter, Büchel, *Chimica inorganica industriale (Inorganic industrial chemistry)*, Piccin, Padua, 1996.
- [5] <http://staff.aist.go.jp/a.noda/programs/ternary/ternary-en.html>, last visited on 27/03/2015.
- [6] <http://www.mathworks.com/matlabcentral/fileexchange/30305-spider-rader-chart-for-multi-data>, last visited on 27/03/2015.

By: Stefano Rizzi

The author works in the analytical chemistry and textile chemistry areas. He has been a Linux user since 1998.